

Chicago Tribune



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TUESDAY, AUGUST 18, 2026

CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Bally's issues warning over liquidity

Going concern raised after construction slowdown at casino

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Days after pausing construction on nearly all non-gaming amenities at its \$1.7 billion casino complex going up in River West, Bally's Corp. issued a going concern warning related to liquidity issues.

The warning, part of Bally's second-quarter earnings filing Friday with the Securities and Exchange Commission, states that the Rhode Island-based company is pursuing "a number of financing alternatives intended to enhance its liquidity" by early next year to stay in compliance with lenders for its revolving credit facility.

Bally's is looking to raise cash through asset sales, an equity offering or debt financing, according to the SEC filing.

"While the company is actively engaged in discussions on several financing alternatives, the conditions and events raise substantial doubt about the company's ability to continue as a going concern," Bally's stated in the filing.

Auditors are required to issue a going concern warning when they believe a company might default on its debt within 12 months. The warning is sometimes a prelude to a bankruptcy filing, and may be a growing concern for investors —

and perhaps the city.

Bally's said the financing issues are connected to future developments and are unrelated to the Chicago construction slowdown, which was implemented as part of its escalating standoff with the city over video gambling terminals.

"There has been no change to the status of Bally's Chicago's construction based off the company's most recent 10-Q filing," the company said in a statement Sunday. "Bally's Chicago remains well situated to

continue delivering on its obligations."

Bally's Chicago issued a reset notice Aug. 8 to the Chicago Community Builders Collective, a general contracting partnership overseeing the casino complex construction, putting everything from the 34-story hotel and events center to a number of planned restaurants on hold, citing the advent of VGTs as a violation of its

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ELECTION 2026
ILLINOIS GOVERNOR

Pritzker accepts teachers' backing

Governor casts doubt on CPS funding push, OKs nod by suburban union

By Olivia Olander
and Jeremy Gerner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Gov. JB Pritzker accepted the backing of Illinois' suburban teachers union Monday and then expressed skepticism about another union's push for more Chicago Public Schools funding — arguing the state can't afford to help Chicago alone without sending money to schools statewide.

"If you'd like, I can pull the pockets out of my trousers to show you that the state does not have dollars that are just laying around," the billionaire governor said when asked about the \$150 million CPS funding push. "And so, the question is, where can we find those dollars?"

The push for CPS funding is exposing fault lines ahead of the General Assembly's fall veto session in November and December, setting up a potential fight over school funding when lawmakers return to Springfield.

Pritzker, a Democrat seeking a third term as governor, made the comments after accepting the endorsement of the Illinois Education Association, which describes itself as the state's largest union and represents educators primarily outside of Chicago.

The IEA's endorsement came just weeks after the CPS board, under pressure from the Chicago Teachers Union, made a high-stakes gamble in passing its nearly \$10 billion budget with \$150 million in additional state funding that isn't currently allocated. The move has raised red flags among observers who have pointed out the state's own budget for the fiscal year passed months ago.

Any deal to send CPS additional funding — whether through reprioritizing existing revenue or a new revenue source — would also need

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ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Fans gear up for Crosstown Classic

White Sox fan Yessenia Rodriguez is surrounded by Cubs fans, including Santiago Gurrola, 7, on her shoulders, as well as Santiago's father, Adhonis Gurrola, 1-year old sister Athena Gurrola and brother Sebastian Gurrola, before the White Sox play the Cubs at Wrigley Field on Monday. **Sports, Page C1**



Salvation Army Auxiliary Captain Jim Prichard, right, works with volunteers during a storm-relief food and water distribution event at Portage High School in Indiana on Thursday. The event was sponsored by the Salvation Army of Northwest Indiana. **ANDY LAVALLEY/FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Northwest Indiana communities frustrated with NIPSCO outages

By Maya Wilkins,
Meredith Colias-Pete
and Michelle L. Quinn
POST-TRIBUNE

As thousands remain without power dating from last Tuesday's storms, northwest Indiana community leaders and residents are frustrated with both the slow pace of restoration and perceived lack of communication with NIPSCO, especially after a Sunday night message on community restoration times neglected to mention some of the hardest-hit communities.

As of 11 a.m. Monday, NIPSCO reported that 102,000 customers remained without power and about 75% of those originated from last Tuesday's storms. At its height, the utility said it had 301,000 outages — which the company said was the largest outage in its history.

Last week, NIPSCO estimated that 90% of customers would receive power back by this Tuesday, Aug. 18, with the remaining 10% resolved by Aug. 21. Sunday's message detailed when specific communities would see a majority of resi-

dents with power restored through Wednesday. The statement didn't mention Gary, Munster, Highland, Lake Station, Portage, Griffith, East Chicago or Hammond — some of the communities with the largest share of outages — and thousands of comments showed the exasperation felt on the company's Facebook post. NIPSCO did clarify that if a community wasn't listed, it may still be under assessment or be part of a larger service area,

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Preliminary deal for US, Iran expires

Trump threatens to bomb ally Oman for role in Hormuz talks

By Aaron Boxerman
THE NEW YORK TIMES

TEL AVIV, Israel — The United States and Iran on Monday missed their 60-day deadline to reach a deal to curtail Iran's nuclear program under the terms of the ceasefire they agreed to in June, underlining the breakdown of a truce that President Donald Trump promised would end the war.

During an interview with Fox News, the president signaled his frustration at his inability to resolve a war that he started by lashing out at a U.S. ally, Oman, that has been trying to mediate negotiations with Iran.

"If Oman gets in the way, we'll bomb ... them," Trump said in a phone interview, according to Fox News' Trey Yingst.

The latest threat toward Oman, which has been negotiating with Iran about the future of the crucial Strait of Hormuz while maintaining that it is still a neutral mediator, came as Trump found himself without much leverage to reach the goals he set out at the start of the war.

Trump had announced the so-called memorandum of understanding between the two countries with great fanfare two months ago. But the short-lived agreement failed to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, which Iran effectively blockaded

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INSIDE

Robbins mayor grazed by bullet

A man was killed by a security guard after he began shooting inside a Robbins bar and restaurant, with bullets grazing two people including Mayor Darren Bryant, according to a village spokesperson. **Chicagoland, A2**

Price report: Many costs slightly easing

According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics, consumer costs are about 3.4% higher compared to a year ago, a subtle improvement from the 3.5% observed in the previous month. **Business**

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